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A large, faint wireframe globe is centered in the background, composed of numerous thin, intersecting lines that create a spherical grid pattern.

RESCUE EXODUS

STUDY GUIDE • 2 OF 5

from slavery to the Promised Land

GENESIS 37 – JOSHUA 6

// START HERE

Welcome to Rescue

Welcome to Rescue. Over seven weeks we follow God's people from slavery toward the Promised Land: Joseph, the burning bush, the Passover and the sea, the Law at Sinai, the tabernacle, the spies at the border, and the crossing into the land. These chapters show a God who sees suffering, rescues, gives instruction and stays with a people on the way. We read for what the text says, ask honest questions and leave each week with one step to try. Come as you are, and bring your questions.

◆ 01 How a session works

90 MIN

The same rhythm every week, so the group can relax into it.

GATHER · 10 MIN

Follow up on last week's step. Did you do it?

READ · 10 MIN

Scripture read aloud, then notes.

DISCUSS · 35 MIN

Questions, not a lecture. Everyone speaks.

ACT · 15 MIN

One step, one outward habit, then prayer.

◆ 02 What you need

BRING

- ◆ A Bible in a translation you trust
- ◆ This guide and a pen
- ◆ Anything else

BETWEEN MEETINGS

- ◆ A few minutes a day with the passage
- ◆ One step to act on
- ◆ One person to tell

◆ 03 About the passages

This guide gives **references only** and does not print Bible text, so read from your own Bible. If you paste text into a page, use a public-domain translation such as the KJV or WEB. Old Testament references use Hebrew-Bible chapter and verse numbering; where an English Bible differs, the English reference is in parentheses. This guide has 7 sessions, in canon order, as part of a five-guide journey from Genesis to Revelation.

// THE FRAME

Our group

Small, steady and weekly. Fixing these early is what lets people open up.

SIZE

6-12

people. Small enough that everyone speaks.

RHYTHM

Weekly

same day, time and place.

SEASON

7

weeks with a steady membership, then regroup.

◆ 01 Details

DAY · TIME

PLACE

LEADER

FACILITATOR
ROTATION

SEASON

CHILD CARE /
FOOD

GROUP CHAT

OPEN / CLOSED

NEXT SEASON

◆ 02 Roster

#	NAME	CONTACT	PRAYER OR CARE NOTE
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			
6			
7			
8			
9			
10			

// AGREED TOGETHER

Our ground rules

Write them, read them aloud in week one, and sign. Edit freely: these are starting points, not commandments.

- 1 Show up and stay for the whole season.
- 2 What is shared here stays here.
- 3 Everyone speaks; no one dominates.
- 4 We may challenge one another kindly, and we agree to be challenged.
- 5 Let Scripture lead; opinions come second.
- 6 Pray for each other between meetings.
- 7 Your own rule

PHRASES FOR CHALLENGING KINDLY

- ◆ “Can you say more about that?”
- ◆ “What does the text say?”
- ◆ “What would it cost you to do that?”
- ◆ Your own phrase

WHEN A RULE IS BROKEN

How we will handle it: who speaks to whom, and how soon.

◆ We agree

Initials and date.

NAME

INITIALS

DATE

// CHOOSE HOW YOU READ

Four ways to study a passage

This guide assigns a method to each session. Change it if your group prefers another.

METHOD 1

Inductive

- ◆ Observe: what does it say?
- ◆ Interpret: what does it mean?
- ◆ Apply: what does it ask of me?

Best for: close reading

METHOD 2

Discovery Bible Study

- ◆ What does it say?
- ◆ What does it say about God? About people?
- ◆ What will I obey?
- ◆ Whom will I tell?

Best for: groups new to the Bible

METHOD 3

Lectio divina

- ◆ Read: a short passage, slowly
- ◆ Meditate: one phrase
- ◆ Pray: respond to God
- ◆ Rest: be still, then share

Best for: prayerful, quieter weeks

METHOD 4

Short accountability

- ◆ Did I do what I said?
- ◆ What did I read this week?
- ◆ Where did I struggle?
- ◆ Whom did I tell or serve?

Best for: pairs, or the opening of any session

◆ Methods in this guide

This guide uses Discovery, Inductive, Lectio divina. Short accountability opens every session in the “Gather” step.

// 7 WEEKS

Our season at a glance

The arc is set; adjust as you go.

WEEK	PASSAGE	THEME	METHOD	LEADS
1	Genesis 37; 45:1-8; 50:15-21	Joseph: betrayed, then reconciled	Inductive	Name
2	Exodus 3	The burning bush	Lectio divina	Name
3	Exodus 12-14	Passover and the sea	Discovery	Name
4	Exodus 19:1-6; 20:1-14 (20:1-17 in English numbering)	The Law at Sinai	Inductive	Name
5	Exodus 25-26	The tabernacle: God among his people	Lectio divina	Name
6	Numbers 13-14	The spies: fear at the border	Discovery	Name
7	Joshua 1-6	Into the land	Inductive	Name

LAST WEEK OF THE SEASON

Celebrate, review what changed, and decide whether to continue, regroup or multiply. Each guide in this set continues the story in canon order, from Genesis to Revelation.

// SESSION 1 OF 7 · INDUCTIVE

Joseph: betrayed, then reconciled

GENESIS 37; 45:1-8; 50:15-21 · LEADS: NAME · DATE

◆ 01 Gather & follow up

10 MIN

Welcome everyone. Read the ground rules aloud (page 4) and share names.

WARM-UP

Share a time you were treated unfairly. Keep it brief.

◆ 02 Read

10 MIN

Read Genesis 37; 45:1-8; 50:15-21 aloud twice, by different voices, in a translation your group trusts.

GENESIS 37; 45:1-8; 50:15-21

◆ 03 Discuss

35 MIN

- 1 **OBSERVE** What stirs up the brothers' hatred (37:3-11), and what do they do (37:18-28)? How does Joseph reveal himself later, and how do the brothers react (45:1-5)?
- 2 **INTERPRET** Joseph says God sent him ahead (45:5-8) and that God meant for good what they meant for harm (50:20). What is he claiming about God, and what is he not claiming about the harm done?
- 3 **APPLY** Forgiveness here takes years and is costly. Where might God be inviting you to forgive, or to seek forgiveness?
- 4 **CHALLENGE KINDLY** Joseph never says what the brothers did was good. How do we avoid both excusing harm and refusing to forgive, in a way that is also safe?

◆ 04 This week's step

10 MIN

What will I obey? Take one step toward forgiveness or reconciliation, and name it. Whom will I tell?

I WILL...

◆ 05 Beyond the group

5 MIN

Support someone who has been wronged or is in prison: write a letter, or support a ministry that visits.

◆ 06 Between sessions

5-10 MIN A DAY

DAY 1

Read Psalm 105:16-22.

DAY 2

Write about a season when God felt silent.

DAY 3

Pray for someone in a dark place.

DAY 4

Do this week's step.

// SESSION 2 OF 7 · LECTIO DIVINA

The burning bush

EXODUS 3 · LEADS: ·

◆ 01 Gather & follow up

10 MIN

Did you do last week's step? What happened?

WARM-UP

Describe a time you felt unheard.

◆ 02 Read

10 MIN

Read Exodus 3 aloud twice, by different voices, in a translation your group trusts.

EXODUS 3

◆ 03 Discuss

35 MIN

- OBSERVE** What does God say in 3:7–10 about seeing, hearing and knowing? How does God introduce himself in 3:6 and 3:14–15?

- INTERPRET** What does the name “I AM” (3:14) suggest about who God is? What does God promise Moses in 3:12?

- APPLY** Moses objects: “Who am I?” (3:11). What reasons do you give when you sense God asking something of you, and what does God say back?

- CHALLENGE KINDLY** God notices suffering and also sends Moses into it. How do we pray for rescue and also take part in it?

◆ 04 This week's step

10 MIN

Identify one concern that moves you (an injustice near you). Pray each day and take one small action.

I WILL...

◆ 05 Beyond the group

5 MIN

Join or support an effort for people who are poor, trafficked or oppressed; give money or time.

◆ 06 Between sessions

5–10 MIN A DAY

DAY 1

Read Exodus 3:1–15 slowly.

DAY 2

Write your own objections to God.

DAY 3

Pray “I AM” as a name to rest in.

DAY 4

Do this week's step.

// SESSION 3 OF 7 · DISCOVERY

Passover and the sea

EXODUS 12-14 · LEADS: NAME · DATE

◆ 01 Gather & follow up

10 MIN

Did you do last week's step? What happened?

WARM-UP

What meal or tradition does your family keep every year?

◆ 02 Read

10 MIN

Read Exodus 12-14 aloud twice, by different voices, in a translation your group trusts.

EXODUS 12-14

◆ 03 Discuss

35 MIN

1 OBSERVE What are the instructions for the first Passover (12:3-14)? What happens that night (12:29-32)?

2 INTERPRET God tells Israel to keep Passover every year as a memorial (12:14). Why might a meal be given as a way to remember? How do the people react at the sea (14:10-12), and what does Moses say (14:13-14)?

3 APPLY Where do you feel stuck between a threat and an obstacle? What would it mean to “stand still” and trust?

4 CHALLENGE KINDLY These chapters include judgment on Egypt. How do we hold God's rescue of one people and the cost to others honestly?

◆ 04 This week's step

10 MIN

What will I obey? Start a simple practice of remembering what God has done, such as a weekly thanks list. Whom will I tell?

I WILL...

◆ 05 Beyond the group

5 MIN

Share a meal with someone in need, remembering God's provision.

◆ 06 Between sessions

5-10 MIN A DAY

DAY 1

Read Exodus 14:13-31.

DAY 2

Write what you are afraid of.

DAY 3

Read the song of Exodus 15:1-18 aloud.

DAY 4

Do this week's step.

// SESSION 4 OF 7 • INDUCTIVE

The Law at Sinai

EXODUS 19:1-6; 20:1-14 (20:1-17 IN ENGLISH NUMBERING) • LEADS: NAME • DATE

◆ 01 Gather & follow up

10 MIN

Did you do last week's step? What happened?

WARM-UP

What is a house rule that actually made your home better?

◆ 02 Read

10 MIN

Read Exodus 19:1-6; 20:1-14 (20:1-17 in English numbering) aloud twice, by different voices, in a translation your group trusts.

EXODUS 19:1-6; 20:1-14 (20:1-17 IN ENGLISH NUMBERING)

◆ 03 Discuss

35 MIN

- 1 **OBSERVE** What has God already done before giving commands (19:4; 20:2)? Which commands are about God and which are about neighbors?

- 2 **INTERPRET** God calls Israel a "kingdom of priests" and a holy nation (19:5-6). Why might God give law after rescue and not before?

- 3 **APPLY** Which commandment do you find easiest to ignore? What would honoring it look like this week?

- 4 **CHALLENGE KINDLY** Jews and Christians relate to the Law in different ways. How can we listen to one another while we ask what these commands show about God and neighbor?

◆ 04 This week's step

10 MIN

Choose one commandment to practice on purpose this week (for example Sabbath rest, honesty, or honoring parents) and tell your partner.

I WILL...

◆ 05 Beyond the group

5 MIN

Honor someone: visit or help an elderly neighbor, or practice generosity.

◆ 06 Between sessions

5-10 MIN A DAY

DAY 1

Read Psalm 19.

DAY 2

Write each commandment as a question to ask yourself.

DAY 3

Pray for help to keep one.

DAY 4

Do this week's step.

// SESSION 5 OF 7 · LECTIO DIVINA

The tabernacle: God among his people

EXODUS 25-26 · LEADS: NAME · DATE

◆ 01 Gather & follow up

10 MIN

Did you do last week's step? What happened?

WARM-UP

Where do you feel most at home, and why?

◆ 02 Read

10 MIN

Read Exodus 25-26 aloud twice, by different voices, in a translation your group trusts.

EXODUS 25-26

◆ 03 Discuss

35 MIN

1 OBSERVE What does God ask Israel to give and make (25:1-9)? What reason does God give for the sanctuary (25:8)?

2 INTERPRET What do the curtains, veil and furnishings (26:1-6, 26:31-37) suggest about approaching God? Why detailed instructions for building?

3 APPLY Where do you sense God's presence? What helps you prepare space, time or heart for God?

4 CHALLENGE KINDLY Traditions differ on how to read the tabernacle and what it points to. What can we all learn from the text about God living among his people?

◆ 04 This week's step

10 MIN

Set aside a small, quiet place or time each day this week for God, and tell your partner what you notice.

I WILL...

◆ 05 Beyond the group

5 MIN

Give or help build something for others: support a community space, church repair, or a neighbor's project.

◆ 06 Between sessions

5-10 MIN A DAY

DAY 1

Read Exodus 25:1-9.

DAY 2

Write where you feel closest to God.

DAY 3

Pray for God's presence in your home.

DAY 4

Do this week's step.

// SESSION 6 OF 7 · DISCOVERY

The spies: fear at the border

NUMBERS 13-14 · LEADS: NAME · DATE

◆ 01 Gather & follow up

10 MIN

Did you do last week's step? What happened?

WARM-UP

What is something you avoided because it felt too big?

◆ 02 Read

10 MIN

Read Numbers 13-14 aloud twice, by different voices, in a translation your group trusts.

NUMBERS 13-14

◆ 03 Discuss

35 MIN

1 **OBSERVE** What do the spies report (13:25-33)? How do the people respond (14:1-4), and what do Joshua and Caleb say (14:6-9)?

2 **INTERPRET** Why does fear spread so quickly? What is the consequence, and what does God's mercy look like alongside it (14:11-20, 14:26-35)?

3 **APPLY** What fear tells you the promise is too hard to enter? What would you do if you trusted God for it?

4 **CHALLENGE KINDLY** The people had good reasons to be afraid. How do we honor real fears without letting them decide for us?

◆ 04 This week's step

10 MIN

What will I obey? Name one fear that keeps you from obeying and take one step despite it. Whom will I tell?

I WILL...

◆ 05 Beyond the group

5 MIN

Encourage someone who is afraid of a next step: go with them to an appointment or sit with them.

◆ 06 Between sessions

5-10 MIN A DAY

DAY 1

Read Numbers 14:5-9.

DAY 2

Write your giants.

DAY 3

Pray for courage for someone else.

DAY 4

Do this week's step.

// SESSION 7 OF 7 · INDUCTIVE

Into the land

JOSHUA 1-6 · LEADS: NAME · DATE

◆ 01 Gather & follow up

10 MIN

Did you do last week's step? What happened?

WARM-UP

Describe starting something new that scared you.

◆ 02 Read

10 MIN

Read Joshua 1-6 aloud twice, by different voices, in a translation your group trusts.

JOSHUA 1-6

◆ 03 Discuss

35 MIN

- 1 **OBSERVE** What does God tell Joshua, and how often does God say to be strong and courageous (1:6, 7, 9)? What does Rahab say about God (2:8-13)? What must the priests do at the Jordan (3:13-17)?

- 2 **INTERPRET** What reason does God give for courage (1:5, 1:9)? Why do the priests step into the water before it parts?

- 3 **APPLY** What new thing is God leading you toward? What would it mean to step in before you see the way?

- 4 **CHALLENGE KINDLY** Joshua 6 includes the fall of Jericho and the destruction of the city (6:20-21). Readers wrestle with this. How do we read it honestly while also seeing Rahab's rescue (6:22-25)?

◆ 04 This week's step

10 MIN

Write one sentence of commitment for the next season and share it. Plan how the group will meet or what comes next.

I WILL...

◆ 05 Beyond the group

5 MIN

Welcome a newcomer to your community or church, as Rahab was welcomed in.

◆ 06 Between sessions

5-10 MIN A DAY

DAY 1

Read Joshua 1:1-9.

DAY 2

Write what is ahead and what scares you.

DAY 3

Pray for someone beginning something new.

DAY 4

Do this week's step.

// PERSONAL REFLECTION

Five days, five short moments

The strongest measured predictor of spiritual growth is reading and reflecting on your own between meetings. Ten minutes is enough. Use the passage from your next session.

◆ 01 Read

10 MIN

Read the week's passage slowly, once. Note the reference.

◆ 02 Notice

10 MIN

Write one line: what stands out?

◆ 03 Ask

10 MIN

Write one question you would ask God about it.

◆ 04 Do

10 MIN

Take this week's step. What happened?

◆ 05 Pray

10 MIN

Pray for the person or place outside the group.

BRING TO NEXT SESSION

One thing you noticed, one question, one result from your step.

// TOGETHER AND BEYOND

Prayer requests

NAME	REQUEST	DATE	ANSWERED

◆ Beyond the group

An outward-facing habit keeps the group from turning inward: people and places we pray for or serve outside the circle.

WHO OR WHERE	PRAY / SERVE	WHEN	DONE

◆ Season project (optional)

One thing we do together for others.

Stand with people on the move: support a refugee-welcome team, a food pantry, or a ministry to people in difficult circumstances.

Project, date, who is leading · Your plan

// FOR THE LEADER

Leader's notes

The leader guides; the group discovers. Ask, listen, and resist teaching the whole passage.

BEFORE

- ◆ Read the passage twice and note your own questions
- ◆ Pick the method and rehearse the four questions
- ◆ Pray for each person by name

AFTER

- ◆ Text a note to anyone who was quiet
- ◆ Log the steps people named
- ◆ Your own follow-up

◆ 01 Timing guide

90 MIN

PART	MIN	NOTES
Gather & follow up	10	<u>Notes</u>
Open in prayer	3	<u>Notes</u>
Read	10	<u>Notes</u>
Discuss	35	<u>Notes</u>
This week's step	10	<u>Notes</u>
Beyond the group · prayer	12	<u>Notes</u>
Buffer	10	<u>Notes</u>

◆ 02 Hard moments in this guide

WHY NOT ME?

Rescue stories can sting for those whose prayers have gone unanswered. Honor both the text and real experiences of pain; never imply faith guarantees a particular outcome.

VIOLENCE IN THE STORY

Exodus and Joshua include judgment and conflict. Acknowledge the difficulty, keep to what the text says, and note that readers wrestle with it.

LAW AND GRACE

Traditions relate to the Law differently. Name that, and keep to what the passages show about God and neighbor.

◆ 03 Session notes

WHY THIS STRUCTURE

Groups reliably build belonging and forgiveness, but showing up does not by itself deepen Bible knowledge or growth. The design leans on discussion, written ground rules, a step to act on, personal reflection between meetings and an outward habit. The 6–12 size and 8–12 week season are practitioner advice, not a measured result.

// SESSION BY SESSION

What to watch for

A short note for each week. Edit freely.

WEEK	PASSAGE	WATCH FOR
1	Genesis 37; 45:1–8; 50:15–21	Forgiveness is not the same as staying in an unsafe situation. If abuse comes up, affirm safety first and never pressure anyone to reconcile.
2	Exodus 3	Do not treat Moses' hesitation as weakness; many members will recognize themselves. Remember that people today still suffer real oppression.
3	Exodus 12–14	Judgment on Egypt is troubling; acknowledge it. Christians connect Passover to the Lord's Supper in different ways; say so neutrally and avoid debate.
4	Exodus 19:1–6; 20:1–14 (20:1–17 in English numbering)	Christian traditions differ on how the Law applies today. Keep the focus on what the passage says and shows about God.
5	Exodus 25–26	The detail can feel dry. Invite the group to notice what the details say about God's care and presence rather than checking every item.
6	Numbers 13–14	Numbers 14 includes a heavy consequence. Acknowledge that it is hard and focus on what the passage says about fear, honesty and God's mercy.
7	Joshua 1–6	Conquest narratives raise hard questions about violence. Stay with the crossing, courage and Rahab; if the group wants to engage the conquest, set aside a separate session. Use this last session to review the season.